

Data Science Study Schedule — Starting July 11, 2026

Pace: 3-4 hrs/day, 6 days/week (Fridays off) → ~18-24 hrs/week **Total:** 30 weeks (~7 months) → **finish around February 5, 2027** **Rule:** finish a phase's checkpoint before moving on, even if it slides a few days past the date below. The calendar is a guide, not a hard deadline — the sequencing is what matters.

Each week runs **Saturday → Thursday**, with **Friday off**.

Month 1 — Python, SQL, Foundations

Week	Dates	Focus
1	Jul 11 - 17	Phase 0 (env setup, 2-3 days) → start Phase 1: NumPy fundamentals
2	Jul 18 - 24	Phase 1: Pandas deep dive (Series/DataFrames/GroupBy/cleaning)
3	Jul 25 - 31	Phase 1: Mini projects (Netflix/FIFA/Spotify) + checkpoint → start Phase 2: SQL basics/intermediate
4	Aug 1 - 7	Phase 2: Advanced SQL (JOINS, CTEs, window functions) + SQL project

Checkpoint by end of Week 4: you can clean a messy CSV and answer business questions unaided, and you're comfortable with window functions in SQL.

Month 2 — Exploratory Data Analysis

Week	Dates	Focus
5	Aug 8 - 14	Phase 3: Data cleaning (missing values, outliers, dtypes) + Statistics Fundamentals playlist
6	Aug 15 - 21	Phase 3: Statistics continued (correlation, z-score, IQR) + Matplotlib
7	Aug 22 - 28	Phase 3: Seaborn + EDA Project 1 (full notebook)
8	Aug 29 - Sep 4	Phase 3: EDA Project 2 + stakeholder-communication write-up + push both to GitHub

Month 3 — Power BI & Review

Week	Dates	Focus
9	Sep 5 - 11	Phase 4: Data import, Power Query, data modeling/star schema
10	Sep 12 - 18	Phase 4: DAX + 3 dashboards (Sales, HR, Financial)
11	Sep 19 - 25	 Review Week — redo a Pandas/NumPy exercise from memory, re-derive z-score/IQR, skim your own notebooks
12	Sep 26 - Oct 2	Phase 5 begins: Regression (Linear/Multiple) + House Price Prediction project

Month 4 — Machine Learning, Part 1

Week	Dates	Focus
13	Oct 3 - 9	Classification (Logistic Regression, KNN) + Customer Churn project
14	Oct 10 - 16	Tree-Based Models (Decision Trees, Random Forest) + Loan Prediction project
15	Oct 17 - 23	Advanced Classical Models (SVM, Naive Bayes) + Spam Classifier project
16	Oct 24 - 30	Unsupervised Learning (K-Means, Hierarchical) + Customer Segmentation project

Month 5 — Machine Learning, Part 2

Week	Dates	Focus
17	Oct 31 - Nov 6	Dimensionality Reduction (PCA) + 2D visualization project
18	Nov 7 - 13	Model Improvement (Cross-validation, Grid/Random Search, Pipelines)

Week	Dates	Focus
19	Nov 14 - 20	Feature Engineering (scaling, encoding, selection) + ML Capstone project
20	Nov 21 - 27	Light NLP (TF-IDF, bag-of-words) + Sentiment Classifier project

Checkpoint by end of Week 20: you can explain why you chose a model and metric for each of the 6+ ML projects you've now built.

Month 6 — NLP/Time Series, Deployment

Week	Dates	Focus
21	Nov 28 - Dec 4	Light Time Series (decomposition, ARIMA/Prophet intuition) + A/B testing basics + Forecast project
22	Dec 5 - 11	Streamlit: deploy Customer Churn Predictor
23	Dec 12 - 18	Streamlit: deploy House Price Predictor + optional FastAPI/Docker
24	Dec 19 - 25	Light week (holidays) — catch-up buffer, or start Kaggle (Titanic/House Prices, read winning notebooks)

Week 24 overlaps Christmas — deliberately built as your lightest week. Use it to catch up if you're behind, or coast ahead if you're on pace. Either is fine.

Month 7 — Portfolio & Interview Prep

Week	Dates	Focus
25	Dec 26 - Jan 1	Light week (New Year's) — Kaggle continued, or portfolio prep if you're ahead
26	Jan 2 - 8	Phase 9: Consolidate GitHub portfolio, rewrite README first paragraphs
27	Jan 9 - 15	Portfolio polish pass + live Streamlit links checked/working
28	Jan 16 - 22	Phase 10: Python/SQL/ML concept review (StatQuest re-watch for weak spots)

Week	Dates	Focus
29	Jan 23 - 29	Phase 10: Behavioral prep — walk through every project (problem/approach/challenges/result/what you'd change)
30	Jan 30 - Feb 5	Final review + start applying

Notes on using this schedule

- **Don't force material into a date.** If Week 15 material needs 8 days instead of 6, take them — just don't skip the checkpoint at the end of each phase.
- **Weeks 24-25 are intentionally light** to protect the plan from holiday burnout — this is where most self-taught schedules break, so it's built in rather than left to chance.
- **Start applying before Week 30 if you're ready.** Once your portfolio (Week 26-27) is solid, there's no reason to wait for "Phase 10 complete" — job searches take weeks themselves, so overlapping the search with final interview prep is normal and smart.
- **If you fall behind by more than ~1 week at any point,** the safest place to compress is Kaggle depth (Week 24) and time series polish (Week 21), not the ML core weeks (12-19) or the portfolio/interview weeks (26-29).